

WXPR ANNUAL REPORT

White Pine Community Broadcasting

FY24
2023-2024



A Note from the GM

Throughout the past year, WXPR remained a trusted source for news, music, and connection across northern Wisconsin and the Upper Peninsula. In a time of change and uncertainty, we stood steady, committed to serving our community with integrity, creativity, and heart.

This year, we shared stories that go beyond the headlines that reflect the depth, resilience, and humanity of the Northwoods. We brought the voices of youth, tribal leaders, small business owners, scientists, educators, and artists to the airwaves, where they could be heard, honored, and celebrated.

Our news team worked tirelessly to deliver in-depth, local reporting on the issues that matter most—public health, the arts, the local economy, environmental policy, and more. During the 2024 election season, we produced a comprehensive, nonpartisan voter guide and expanded our coverage to help listeners feel informed, empowered, and confident when casting their votes at the ballot box.

WXPR's dedication to music and culture remained a powerful force. We hosted another unforgettable Project North Festival, filling downtown Rhineland with music, art and community pride. Our concert series gave regional musicians a stage, and our volunteer hosts continued to craft local music programming that honors the sound and story of the Northwoods.

Every story told, every note played, and every event hosted reaffirmed our commitment to being more than just a station, we're a platform for community connection, a catalyst for conversation, and a champion for the people who live here.

To our members: thank you. Your support, encouragement, and belief in the power of local public radio make this work possible and meaningful.

As we look ahead, we do so with hope and determination. The media landscape may be shifting, but our purpose is clear. The need for music, for trusted local journalism, and for authentic storytelling has never been greater and WXPR is ready to meet that moment, with you by our side.

Thank you for being part of this journey and an integral part of WXPR Public Radio.

Sincerely,



Jessie Dick

General Manager & President
WXPR Public Radio

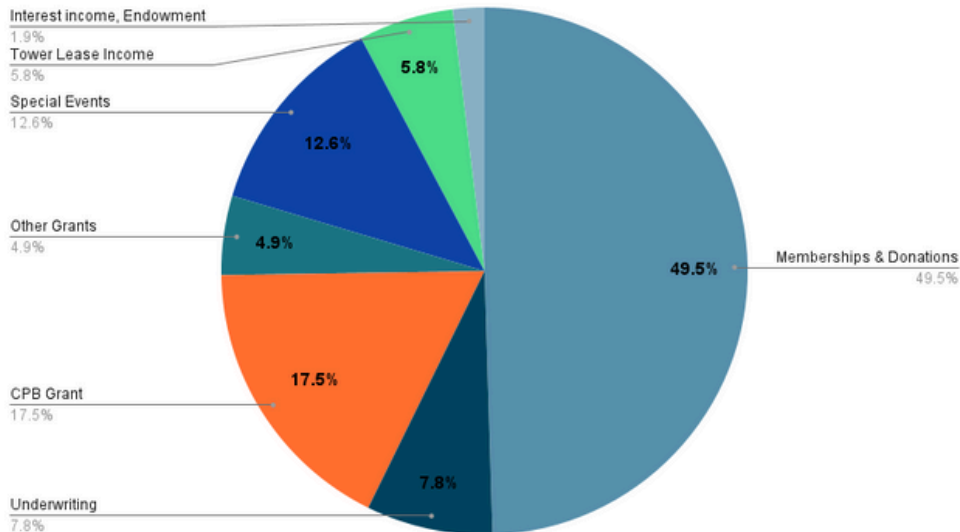




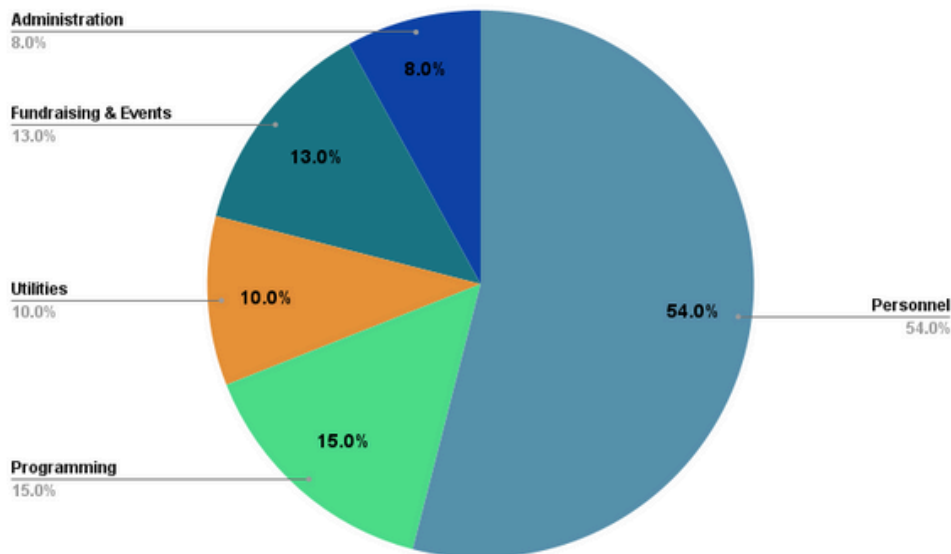
Numbers at a Glance

WXPR Financials Fiscal Year 2024

Income: \$843,961



Expenses \$879,501





Board Members & Staff

WXPR Board of Directors

The Board of Directors is responsible for management and operation of White Pine Community Broadcasting Inc. WXPR

- Suzanne Flory — Board Chair
- Gami Miller — Vice Chair
- Alison Pichowski — Secretary
- Ralph Solome Jr. — Treasurer
- Jane Banning
- Susan Bronson
- John Harris
- Tony Hjelle
- Carly Lapin
- Chris Moran
- Jenny Sadak
- Jon Simonsen

WXPR Community Advisory Board

The Community Advisory Board is a volunteer group of listeners that meets three times a year to make programming recommendations.

- Meredyth Albright
- Brittany Beyer
- Brian Derber
- Carly Lapin
- Gami Miller
- Dan O'Rourke
- Traci Stinebrink

WXPR Staff

- Galen AzBell — Director of Operations and Technology
- John Burton — Morning Edition Host
- Eileen Daniel — Development Associate
- Jessie Dick — General Manager
- Colleen Finn — Volunteer Coordinator
- Phoebe Spier — Development Director
- Katie Thoresen — News Director





Station Volunteers

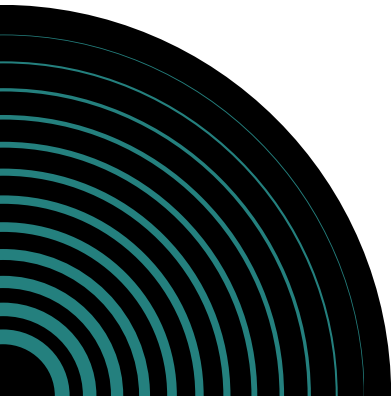
WXPR is tremendously lucky to have almost 50 active and dedicated on-air volunteers. We also have a handful of folks who support our on-air work. Our volunteers range in age from their early twenties to eighty and beyond with years of service extending from one month to thirty-nine years. The quality of our music programming epitomizes musical diversity. This impressive group of people display commitment to content and authenticity in their music sets show after show. There is no way to sufficiently thank the folks listed below for bringing their knowledge, enthusiasm and good will to the WXPR studio — WXPR would not exist without them.

Meredyth Albright	Nicole Filizetti	Chris Houlette	Maggie Rose Kush	Gordon Patriarca
Ardis Berghoff	Colleen Finn	Tom Jasper	Marilyn Larson	Nancy Richmond
Brooke Behrle	Doug Ferrel	Bill Johnson	Doug Malinsky	Katie Simonsen
Kerry Bloedorn	Patty Fitzpatrick	Allie Johnson	Michael McDermott	Mike Smolarek
Jaz Brown	Andrew Grawien	John Jursa	Carolyn Nottle	Susan Spangenberg
Jeff Burke	Richard Gsell	Mark Kaetzer	Carol Pekol	Theresa Seabloom
Randy Burl	Craig Harrison	Warren Kmiec	Jim Pekol	Jeremy Starz
James Cape	Hunter Hapka	Bill Kopanda	Marilyn Pekol	Molly Rose Teuke
Dawn Edwards	John Hein	Ken Krall	Jeff Pennucci	Brandi Wayt
			Matt Persike	Renee Wink

Thank you, WXPR Volunteers, for all you do!



Colleen Finn
Volunteer Coordinator



WXPR News Update

WXPR News remains focused on delivering local news to the Northwoods.

In 2024, WXPR published more than 800 stories by the WXPR news team and our local news partners. Coverage including the ongoing PFAS contamination in Oneida County and the roads dispute in Lac du Flambeau.

We also refocused our journalism to dial in on solutions in the region. The WXPR news team took part in an eight-month long rural cohort through the Solutions Journalism Network. It helped us launch our Solutions Journalism initiative which takes a look at what's working, what's not, and how we know that. Through this initiative we've brought you stories efforts to restore wild rice and communities trying new things to bring in visitors during the low snow winter.

The WXPR News team earned a Regional Edward R. Murrow Award for its coverage of the Pelican River Forest the previous year.

WXPR is now part of Harvest Public Media. It is a Local Journalism Center, established in 2010 with the support of a grant from the Corporation for Public Broadcasting. The initiative was intended to strengthen collaboration among Midwest public broadcasting stations. Stories from this partnership focus on agriculture and rural issues. From partner stations we've heard stories about the impact of the mass layoffs at USDA, how more builders are using wood to construct high rises, and why more farmers are planting native plants in their crop fields. WXPR has contributed stories about wild rice restoration and forest generated carbon credits.



Katie Thoresen
News Director & Vice President



John Burton
Morning Edition Host & Reporter





WXPR Operations & Technology Update

In 2024, WXPR continued its work to further develop technological systems that enable us to serve the Northwoods and the global WXPR community. We also worked to find new ways to utilize our current systems, as well as make sure these systems were maintained and in compliance with all laws and regulations.

Some of this work was directly visible to our listeners. For example, we utilized a previously developed system that allowed for easy streaming playback of previously broadcast local music shows in a new way, reaching out to the producers of two syndicated shows we had added to our weekly schedule that had no easy way for mobile device listeners to stream them. Working with those producers and our app development team, our station's app became the first one to ever offer those shows in a streaming format that is available for listeners whenever they want them. Alongside all of our locally produced music shows and locally produced podcasts and news reporting, the Recent Shows page of our app offers a deep library of enriching and enlightening listening that's constantly being updated with new content.

Beyond our streaming content, we also worked to bring excellent programming to our listeners throughout the year. Above and beyond our excellent regular schedule, we were able to deliver dozens of hours of special programming across the year. Sometimes this was for holidays and historical events - whether we were making sure the Splendid Table's Turkey Confidential was there to answer listeners' Thanksgiving Day kitchen questions, delivering an NPR special report on the life and legacy of former President Jimmy Carter shortly after his passing, exploring the historical experiences and contributions of African Americans in multiple special programs across Black History Month, or celebrating the Christmas season with (among many holiday shows!) our News Director Katie Thoreson and her favorite classic holiday music, WXPR brought listeners programming that deepened their understanding and connection with those events. Beyond holidays and events, we also were able to bring multiple live performances to our listeners through our Live from the White Pine series, as well as interviews with artists done by WXPR volunteers.

Some of our other work wasn't as apparent to our listeners but played an essential role in serving them all the same. For example, many of those artist interviews and interviews we did for news stories were done using a new telephone system we installed at the station this year which allows WXPR staff to make phone calls, record interviews, and edit them in the field as easily as they do back at the station. Additionally, we repaired and replaced essential systems at our transmission sites to make sure our FM broadcasts stay strong and reliable. Finally, it should also be mentioned that we worked behind the scenes with our partners in the Emergency Alert System that all broadcasters participate in to coordinate tests of that system to make sure everyone receives these lifesaving messages when they go out.



Galen AzBell

Director of Operations & Technology



Community Engagement & Development Update

When people ask me, “What is development?” my answer is simple: development means *relationships*. At WXPR, that means building the connections that keep this station strong—through individual memberships, business sponsorships, community partnerships, and events. Public radio is powered by people, and as a community station, relationships aren’t just important—they’re everything.

You’ve probably heard the message: “WXPR: people you know.” We want everyone to know us—and to feel known in return. Because when people feel connected to WXPR, they’re also more connected to each other. That’s how strong communities grow.

In my first year here, I’ve seen firsthand how powerful that connection can be. WXPR is more than a radio station—it’s a place where stories spark conversations, where tradition meets innovation, and where relationships make it all possible.

This year, we’ve deepened those connections while extending our reach. In FY24, we received support from donors in 40 states, 1 U.S. territory, and even another country (Canada). We’re grateful for every gift—whether through sustaining memberships, vehicle donations, DAFs, in-kind trades, or year-end contributions. We now have more than 1,500 members, including 526 sustainers, as well as 70 business underwriters (20 supporting annually), and an average of 47,000 unique website visitors each month.

And yet, only about 10% of our listeners give financially—reminding us just how much opportunity we have to grow deeper relationships and invite more people into the WXPR family.

It’s been a big year for our small-but-mighty Development Team, too. We said goodbye to longtime team member Emily Irwin and welcomed Eileen Daniel as our new Development Associate. Together, we manage all the station’s relationships through membership, underwriting, outreach, social media, and more—with the shared goal of nurturing the connections that keep this station thriving.

As we look ahead, our focus remains clear: building strong connections, on the air and in our communities. Because WXPR’s greatest strength will always be the people behind it—and the people who believe in it.



Phoebe Spier
Development Director



Eileen Daniel
Development Associate



Relationships by the Numbers — FY24 Edition

At WXPR, everything we do starts with people — and this year, the numbers show just how far our community reaches!

We're Connected!

- *We have members in 40 states, 1 U.S. territory, and Canada!*
- *1,314,991 page views on wxpr.org*
- *~47,000 unique monthly website visitors*
- *4,800 Facebook followers*
- *1,660 Instagram followers*
- *2000+ Unique App Users*

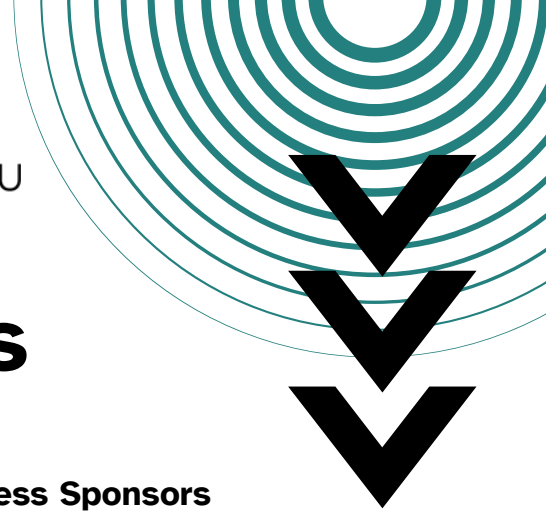
Powered by You

- *1,500+ members*
- *526 sustaining members – the heartbeat of our station*
- *70 business underwriters (20 giving year-round)*

In Your Inbox

- *2,000+ newsletter subscribers*
- *46% open rate (that's way above the industry average!)*





Business Underwriters

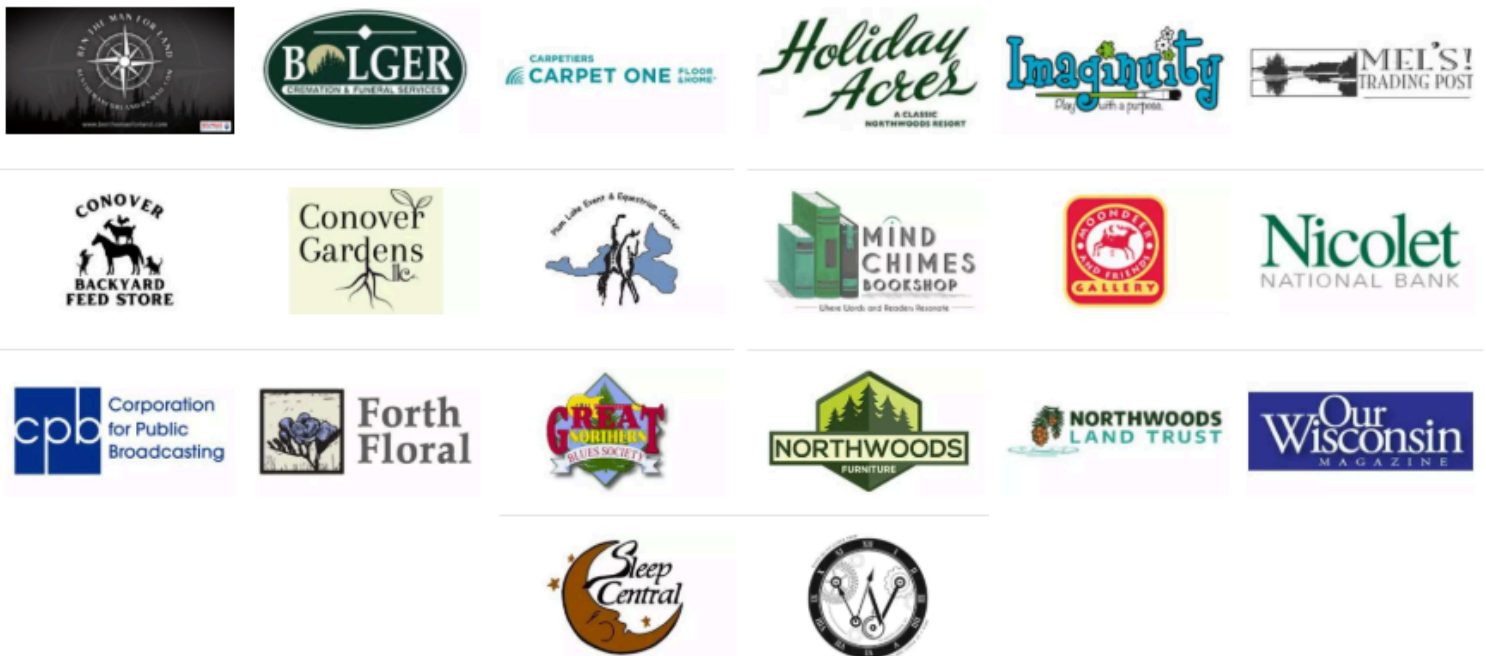
The Power Behind the Mic: Celebrating Public Radio Business Sponsors

Public radio thrives on connection—stories shared, voices heard, and communities brought closer together. Behind every broadcast is a network of local businesses that help make it possible.

WXPR's business sponsors are more than underwriting messages—they are champions of independent journalism, diverse music, and community programming. These partners share our values of informed citizenship, vibrant culture, and thoughtful dialogue.

Their support strengthens local storytelling and reflects a deep commitment to community media. We're grateful for the vital role they play in sustaining WXPR's mission and impact.

WXPR Annual Sponsors:



Visit wxpr.org/business-sponsors for a full list of sponsors.



More Business Sponsors & Partnerships

Amanda Anderson Creative
American Carpet Cleaning
Ann Marie's
ArtStart
Artistree Gallery
Blue Ox Music Festival
Boulder Junction Chamber of Commerce
Chequamegon Adventure Company
Clarion Pointe by Choice Hotels
Crate Digger's Music & More
CT's Deli
Emberlight Festival
Friends of The Porkies
Friends of Wabeno
Golden Pear Interiors
Happy The Hodag
Harmonious Wail
Headwaters Council for the Performing Arts
Howard Young Foundation
Lake Superior Big Top Chautauqua
Land O Lakes Arts
MECCA Trails
Midwest Gypsy Swing Fest
Midsummer Bluegrass Fest
Morgan Stanley- The Lakeland Group
Nativity Catholic School

Nicolet College
Nicolet Live!
Nicolet Studio of Lakewood
Northwoods Art Tour
Northwoods Community Garden
Northwoods Pride
Northwoods Star Journal
Northern Lakes Chapter - Wisconsin Society of Land Surveyors
Oneida County Development Corporation
Rhineland Area Chamber of Commerce
Rhineland District Library
Science On Tap- Minocqua
SISU Dirt Crew
St. Anthony Spirituality Center
T. Lauder Pottery & Printmaking
The Hilgermann Center for Community
The Historic Ironwood Theatre
The Pines Event Center
Three Lakes Area Chamber of Commerce
Vilas County News Review
WAOW TV9
Wabeno Area Players
WAM Fest (Wabeno Art and Music Fest)
Whitewater Music Hall
WJFW TV12
Wisconsin Senior Medicare Patrol

We have immense gratitude for our sponsors for helping keep independent, listener-powered radio alive in the Northwoods. Their support fuels local journalism, diverse music, and the connections that bring our community closer!

Visit [wxpr.org/business-sponsors](https://www.wxpr.org/business-sponsors) for a full list of sponsors.





Awards

This year, WXPR News continued to uphold its commitment to excellence in journalism, earning a Regional Edward R. Murrow Award in the small market radio category. The award, given for Best Continuing Coverage, was presented to reporters Katie Thoresen and John Burton for their in-depth reporting on the Pelican River Forest.

This recognition is part of WXPR's ongoing success in the prestigious Murrow Awards competition. Since the station began entering in 2022, WXPR has received more than six Regional Edward R. Murrow Awards, reinforcing its reputation for outstanding local news coverage.

The Murrow Awards, presented by the Radio Television Digital News Association (RTDNA), are among the most prestigious honors in broadcast and digital journalism. These awards celebrate news organizations that demonstrate the spirit of excellence set by Edward R. Murrow, a pioneer in the profession.

WXPR is proud to deliver high-quality, award-winning reporting that informs and engages our listeners across the Northwoods.



EDWARD R. MURROW
AWARDS
2024 WINNER

Community Engagement

Collaboration remains at the heart of WXPR's mission, strengthening our connection to the Northwoods community through meaningful partnerships. This year, we expanded our engagement with a diverse range of organizations, fostering new relationships and deepening existing ones to enhance local arts, culture, and public service initiatives.

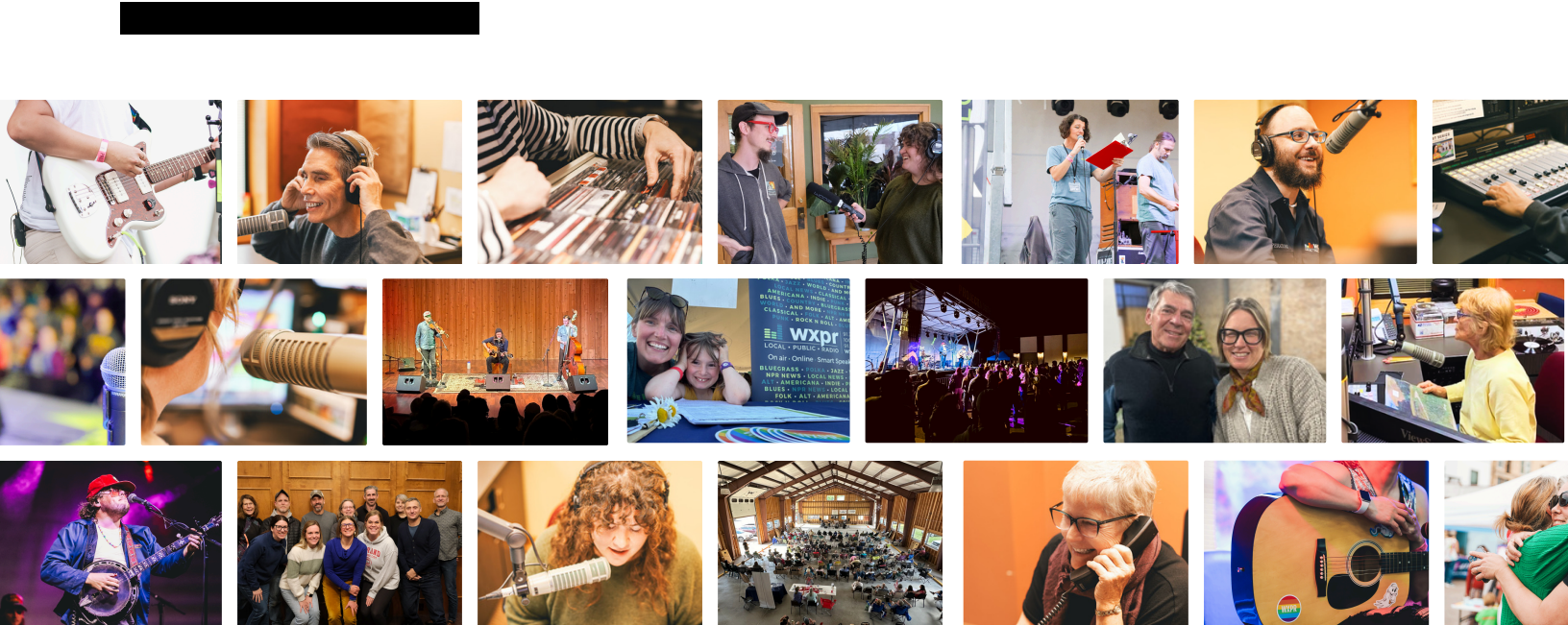
From celebrating music and storytelling with Lake Superior Big Top Chautauqua, Midwest Gypsy Swing Fest, and Blue Ox Music Festival, to supporting local arts through partnerships with ArtStart, Land O' Lakes Arts, and The Historic Ironwood Theatre, WXPR continues to champion creative expression. Our work with Nicolet College and Science On Tap-Minocqua has helped bring insightful discussions on important topics to our listeners.

Community service remains central to our efforts, with partnerships extending to organizations like Howard Young Foundation, Northwoods Community Garden, and SISU Dirt Crew, reflecting our commitment to health, sustainability, and outdoor engagement. We've also strengthened our ties with local business and civic organizations, including the Boulder Junction, Rhineland, Eagle River and Three Lakes Area Chambers of Commerce, helping to amplify regional voices and initiatives.

Our collaborations with Northwoods Pride and Northwoods JEDI highlight our dedication to inclusivity and informed storytelling, ensuring all voices in our community are represented. As a public service agency, WXPR remains committed to building relationships, listening to our audience, and creating meaningful connections that enrich the Northwoods.



Thank You, WXPR Community, for a wonderful year!



Contact WXPR

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WXPR is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit:

White Pine Community Broadcasting, Inc.

Federal Tax ID: 39-1341618

